

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Kousalya Iyengar

Address: 151 Banstead Road South Sutton SM2 5LL

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I object to this proposal on the grounds of Negative Highway Safety & Traffic Impact and Inadequate Parking Provision.

I regularly travel up and down Dorset Road, Avenue Road, York Road and Holland Avenue. As it is, during school pick up and drop off times, it takes well over 10 mins to travel from Belmont Station to the junction of Dorset Road and Holland Road. There are cars stopped on both sides of the road, kids darting across the traffic. Buses that pass down the road are frequently held up and delayed. Currently, there is some respite outside pick-up and drop-off times and during term holidays. The junction of Station Road, Avenue Road and Northdown Road is another chokehold, especially when there are events held at St John's Church.

With a mosque and a community hall, now the traffic will be near constant. Even with staggered prayer times, the 12 proposed parking spots are not going to be sufficient for the needs of the attendees. And where are the attendees going to park? - Up York Road, Holland Avenue, Balmoral Way - places that already suffer from inconsiderate parking. Just like the school, the mosque will send out a letter requesting everyone to be considerate to their neighbours - it will have an impact for a couple of days and then ignored subsequently.

In addition to the school, there are nursing homes and a Bowling club in the vicinity that cater to an elderly demographic. All the increased traffic and chaos pose a significant risk to the existing users of the neighbouring roads. It is not sufficient to say that you will increase parking wardens in the area. What about later in the evenings or the weekends? What will be the impact on the response times of emergency services that need to pass through these roads?

In response to comments that I see on the planning application:

- The increased footfall and vehicular traffic is unlikely to be confined to Friday afternoons.
- The traffic and noise associated with the Ambulance service was excused because they provided a valuable life-saving service.
- The increased traffic when the community events are held at St John's Church is definitely visible and a nuisance for those who live nearby or travel through.
- There is a large mosque on A232, barely a mile from the proposed location, which should be able to cater to religious needs of the community. There is another on Oakhill Road, and a prayer hall on Woodstock Road. Compared to other minority faiths, one could say that the Muslims are well catered to in the provision of prayer and community spaces, in London Borough of Sutton.
- No one wants the site to remain disused, but given the location, it is better suited to a secular provision that aims to attract a significantly lower number of attendees and is built with a significantly larger number of parking spaces within the site.

I hope the council recognises the stress placed on the neighbourhood and rejects the proposal.